religion so they worshiped Mwari who was the supreme god. In 1430, Prince Nyatsimba Mutota traveled north in search of salt and other commercial goods. After a short battle, he conquered the northern region, which later became known as the Kingdom of Mutapa.

This new kingdom grew aggressively with trade and became an economic power of its day. In 1450, it eventually eclipsed Zimbabwe entirely, as most of the people had abandoned the territory. The end of the empire resulted in fragmentation of tribes and two new kingdoms appeared: the Mutua in the north, which kept all of Zimbabwe's administrative structure but not the masonry tradition, and the kingdom of Butua in the south, which was an identical smaller version of the Kingdom of Zimbabwe. Later, both of these kingdoms merged to become the largest and most influential state of the Kalanga states, known as the Rozwi Empire.

Some theorize that the splitting up of the kingdom of Zimbabwe was environmental because the combination of overgrazing and drought caused the soiled to become exhausted. What once was an ideal plain of fertile land became rapidly useless. Others have suggested that the kingdom of Zimbabwe wanted to maximize the gold trade. The people therefore needed to find new trade centers and had to travel further across the land to achieve their goals.